PMO Governance Rulebook

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How the PMO dashboard is defined, run and kept trustworthy. Targets are proposals to agree with the sponsor, not fixed rules.

KPIs

KPI	Definition	Target	Owner
Cost variance	Forecast at completion vs budget	5% over or less	Finance partner
Schedule slip	Forecast end vs baseline end	7 days or less	Project manager
Projects green	Share of projects whose calculated colour is Green	60% or more	PMO
Status accuracy	Share of projects where reported colour equals calculated colour	90% or more	PMO
Resource utilization	Hours logged divided by hours allocated	85 to 100%	Department head
Data freshness	Share of projects updated in the last 30 days	100%	Project manager

Benefit realization	Realized savings divided by pro-rated target to date	90% or more	Project sponsor

Colour rules

- Red projects require the forecast cost to be over budget by more than 15%, the predicted end date to be more than 30 days late, or the forecast savings to be below the expected by more than 25%. Amber projects have the forecast cost over by 5%, the predicted end date to be more than 8 days late, or the forecast savings to be below the expected by more than 10%. Green projects have none of the three issues mentioned above. The color is determined based on the worst-case scenario.
- The PMO will propose all changes in writing, describing how many projects would change colors based on the new requirements. The finance leadership will approve the changes during the month's closing meeting, and the changes will be implemented from the subsequent reporting month, also reflected in the change log.
- The project managers will not be able to change the calculated color of their projects. They will be required to justify the discrepancy in the status comment if their calculated color differs from the submitted one.

Adoption plan

1. **Find the pain points:** The pain points should be identified by talking with several project managers and department heads to understand what needs improvement in the current system.
2. **Pilot with two departments:** The tool can be piloted in two departments by asking them to use the dashboard in their following project meeting for a couple of weeks.
3. **Train local champions:** Local champions can be appointed by identifying one person per department who will learn the material and teach it to their colleagues.
4. **Track usage and follow up:** Usage should be tracked and followed up on. The data freshness, utilization, and status accuracy should be reviewed per department monthly, and one corrective action should be taken with the departments that underperform.

Stakeholders

Group	What they want	How to engage

Project managers	Less reporting effort, fair treatment of Red projects	Simple update routine, champion support
Department heads	Early warning on cost, dates and time logging	Monthly department view, input on targets
Finance leadership	Reliable forecasts and proven savings	Monthly review, approval of colour rules
PMO	One trusted view of the portfolio	Owns the dashboard, runs workshops and reviews

Meeting rhythm

Kick-off workshop (60 minutes, per department): purpose and demo (15), colour rule and KPIs (15), each project manager updates one project (20), open questions and next steps (10).

Monthly governance review (45 minutes, after month end): KPIs against targets (10), Red projects and recovery actions (20), status mismatches and stale projects (10), rule changes, access requests and actions (5).

Access requests

1. The person or their line manager submits a request with name, department, role and access level (view or edit).
2. The line manager confirms the need.
3. The PMO approves.
4. The tool administrator creates or changes the account and confirms.

Target turnaround is 3 working days. The PMO reviews accounts quarterly and removes leavers' access promptly.
